

Activity 5 – Secure, Safe, and Sustainable AI

One Small, Realistic Commitment

Purpose

Make **one small, realistic commitment** about how you will use (and talk about) AI in your own unit, project, or role – in a way that is **secure, safe, and sustainable**.

This activity assumes we already know that tools like **Microsoft Copilot** and **Turnitin Clarity** exist, and that there may have been a **heavier ethics/policy discussion** earlier (e.g., in an Assessment 2030 session). Here, we focus on **practical next steps**, not re-stating all the risks.

Option A – Full Micro-Task (10–15 minutes)

Use this version if the group still has energy to work directly with AI.

Step 1 – Choose ONE micro-task

Pick whichever feels most useful for your context **right now**:

1. Draft a short “**AI use in this unit/team**” guideline
2. Run a quick **risk/benefit check** on one planned AI use
3. Draft a short **Week 1 statement** you can say to students/staff about AI

You can do this by hand or with AI support.

Option 1 – Unit / Team AI Use Guideline

Prompt template:

You are advising educators / professional staff at an Australian university on safe use of generative AI tools (e.g., Microsoft Copilot).

Draft a short “**AI use in this unit / team**” guideline.

Include:

- 3–4 “**Do**” points (good use cases)
 - 3–4 “**Don’t**” points (e.g., student data, confidential documents, unacknowledged AI use)
 - A one-sentence reminder to check institutional policy.
- Keep it under **200 words** and use plain language.

Edit the output so it:

- Fits your **tone** and context
- Aligns with your **school/faculty policy**
- Expresses your own view of AI as a **tool**, not a replacement

Option 2 – Risk / Benefit Check for One Planned AI Use

Prompt template:

You are an AI risk advisor.

I plan to use AI in this way in my work:

[describe intended use, e.g., "Use Copilot to draft weekly announcements and example feedback comments"].

Identify:

- Key benefits for my workload and for students/staff
- Main risks (privacy, bias, over-reliance, academic integrity, misinformation)
- 3 practical safeguards I should put in place to manage these risks in line with typical Australian university policies.

Decide which benefits and safeguards **actually apply** in your context, and note any actions you want to take.

Option 3 – Week 1 Statement for Students or Staff

Prompt template:

You are helping me frame AI use in my [unit / team / project] in a way that supports “**human irreplaceability**” (e.g., Assessment 2030).

Suggest **3 short statements** I can say in Week 1 that:

- Acknowledge that AI tools exist and can be helpful
- Emphasise that people’s unique value is in their judgement, experience, and context

- Encourage **transparent, responsible use**, not hidden or over-reliant use.
- Keep each statement under **40 words** and use friendly, clear language.

Choose one you like as a starting point, and rewrite it in **your own voice**.

Option B – Light Version (5–7 minutes)

Use this version if there has already been a **heavy ethics / policy session** and energy is low. No AI use required.

Step 1 – Draft **ONE** clear sentence

On your own, write **one sentence** you could say in Week 1 about AI use in your context. For example:

- For students in a unit you teach
- For research students in your group
- For staff you support in a professional service

Your sentence should:

- Acknowledge that AI tools exist
- Emphasise that **human judgement / learning** still matters
- Indicate what is **allowed / expected** in your context

Examples to adapt:

- “You are welcome to use AI tools to brainstorm and draft ideas in this unit, but you are responsible for checking accuracy and making the final decisions.”
- “AI can help with first drafts and summaries, but your unique value is in your judgement, experience, and ability to improve on those drafts.”
- “If you use AI for your work, be transparent: tell me what you used it for and what you changed.”

Step 2 – Share (optional)

If there is time and appetite, share your sentence with your table or the whole room. Notice the different ways people balance **openness, trust, and integrity** in how they talk about AI.

Variants for Researchers and Professional Staff

You can adapt Options A or B to your specific role.

If you are mainly doing research

Possible micro-tasks:

- Draft a short “**AI in this project**” statement for an ethics application or methods section.
- Run a risk/benefit check on using AI to:
 - analyse transcripts
 - summarise articles
 - draft sections of a paper.
- Write a Week 1 message for **HDR students** about when and how AI may be used (and documented) in their work.

If you are in a professional / administrative role

Possible micro-tasks:

- Draft a **team-level guideline**: what your office will and will not use AI for (e.g., drafting comms vs handling student records).
 - Run a quick risk check on using AI to summarise internal documents or write student information pages.
 - Write a sentence for **staff orientation** or **student-facing materials** that sets expectations about AI use in your area.
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Reflection / Notes

Use the prompts below and the space provided.

- What small commitment did you make or draft in this activity (guideline, safeguard, or statement)?
- How does it reflect a **balanced view** of AI (neither banning nor blind adoption)?
- What is one follow-up action you could take in the next month (e.g., add this to a unit outline, syllabus, team charter, or induction slide)?

(Notes:)

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